
FUP from our meeting

5 messages

Ronnie Bouchon <ronniebouchon@gmail.com>
To: "David R. Tarpy" <david_tarpy@ncsu.edu>

Tue, Jul 28, 2026 at 8:15 AM

David,

Great catching up at breakfast — wanted to send a quick follow-up with where things stand and a few loose ends from our conversation.

Updates since we talked:

On the outreach front: I've reached back out to Debbie Delaney and Julia Mahood (mapmydca.com) in case they circle back to you.

A few things I'm still hoping to get from you when you have a chance:

- That short bio synopsis for the site, whenever you get a minute to write it
- Names for the Southern California Africanized bee research group. I found some information at [UC Riverside](http://UCRiverside), or is it more the UC Davis genetics folks??
- Any contact you're able to pass along at [NC State Extension \(Wake County\)](http://NCStateExtension(WakeCounty))?
- Best contact for the [Wake County Beekeepers Association](http://WakeCountyBeekeepersAssociation)?
- Any contacts for the "Cradle of Forestry" — the actual Heritage Site in Pisgah National Forest, or Uwharrie, or the Great Dismal Swamp?

Just wanted to keep the thread alive while it's fresh. Thanks,

— Ronnie Bouchon

919-649-0446

David Tarpy <drtarpy@ncsu.edu>
To: Ronnie Bouchon <ronniebouchon@gmail.com>

Tue, Jul 28, 2026 at 10:58 AM

Hi Ronnie,

You might try this contact for the Cradle of the Forest:

Devin Gentry
Director of Operations
Cradle of Forestry in America
Devin@cfaia.org
Office: 828-884-5713 x221
Cell: 828-553-5021

And Boris Baer is the best person at Riverside:

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profiles.ucr.edu



As for Wake County, there isn't really a good contact through the county extension office, and the best person to contact for the beekeepers is the current President on their website (not sure who it is off hand).

Sorry, I'm out of town at a conference and not firing on all cylinders...

Sincerely, David

David R. Tarpy
Professor and Extension Apiculturist
Department of Applied Ecology
Campus Box 7617
North Carolina State University
Raleigh, NC 27695-7617
TEL: (919) 515-1660
LAB: (919) 513-3967
WEB: <http://entomology.ces.ncsu.edu/profile/david-tarpy/>
EMAIL: david_tarpy@ncsu.edu

Shipping Address:
NC State Queen & Disease Clinic
112 Derieux Place
Thomas Hall-Room 1560
Raleigh, NC 27607
TEL: 919-513-3967

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[Beekeeper Education & Engagement System \(BEES\)](#)
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Ronnie Bouchon <ronniebouchon@gmail.com>
To: David Tarpy <drtarpy@ncsu.edu>

Tue, Jul 28, 2026 at 12:02 PM

Hey David,

Thanks for getting those contacts over while you're out of town. That's really helpful.

I'll look up the President for the Wake County group. Still need that bio synopsis and any leads on Uwharrie/Dismal Swamp when you get a chance.

Best, Ronnie

Thanks, Ronnie
[Quoted text hidden]



David Tarpy <drtarpy@ncsu.edu>
To: Ronnie Bouchon <ronniebouchon@gmail.com>

Wed, Jul 29, 2026 at 8:02 AM

Hi Ronnie,

Apologies, it wasn't the Dismal Swamp but the Holly Shelter Gameland (see thread and contact below).

And attached is a standard bio that I've used in the past, let me know if that works for you, thanks!

Still haven't seen Debbie yet but will chat with her.

Sincerely, David

From: Ryan Ross <Ryan@freebeesapiary.com>
Sent: Monday, June 5, 2023 12:35 PM
To: mbp@ncbeekeepers.org
Cc: David Tarpy <drtarpy@ncsu.edu>
Subject: Master Craftsman Project

Hello if there is a way someone from the committee could contact me I would appreciate it. My name is Ryan Ross I'm in Wilmington, Nc. Phone number is 910-612-5842. I just dropped off live bees to Dr. David Tarpy at NC State for genetics testing. Here's the condensed version of our project. My wife Jenifer Tucker and I have a scientific research permit through NC wildlife commission to trap feral non managed honey bees in Holly Shelter Gameland. We have started putting swarm boxes over 90,000 acre area. It took almost 6 months to get the approval and permits. We started with first boxes Memorial Day only because it's took so long to get approval. We have successfully trapped one colony and documented size (population) color of bees and did a alcohol wash mite test. Then took another 300 live bees to Dr. Tarpy for genetics testing whether they have Africanized traits or any diseases or even pathogens in their system. Dr. Tarpy has been very excited for this project. My question is my wife and I are on our journeyman now been working through David bridgers master craftsman here in Wilmington.

If we both are striving to get our master craftsman we can't do any of this alone. It's just me and her together but both want to get credit for all the work. We have two different projects going on. Mine is are all these feral bees in gameland infested with mites or are they building a tolerance. Jens project is are the feral bees here related or have Africanized traits being we have container chips from china coming in everyday or pathogens/diseases being from non managed hives in the wild. Both projects require both of us so we are doing this for the next 3 years we have approval. I'd hate to see both of us do all of this work and one not get credit for it. I'm also working with Mr. Thomas Seeley at Cornell on this project. He has helped me by sending all of his research from his extensive field test and helping with placement of the boxes and location. Please let me know you received this email thank you.

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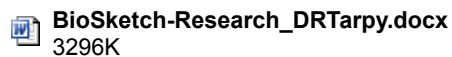
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919-649-0446

2 attachments



Ronnie Bouchon <ronniebouchon@gmail.com>
To: David Tarpy <drtarpy@ncsu.edu>

Wed, Jul 29, 2026 at 8:19 AM

Thanks David, I will reach out to Ryan!

Also, I just did a large update and added a landing page, to make SaveTheHives.org a bit more approachable rather than just landing on a map!

Thanks, Ronnie

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